

## WEEK 4 OF 4 · Spirit

**Script 4: The Inner Bow (Self-Compassion)****Theme: Kindness to Oneself**

*Rationale: Martial artists are often hard on themselves. This script frames self-compassion not as weakness, but as the same respect one extends to the dojo, the instructor, and a training partner. You would not yell at a white belt who is trying their best.*

*Request meditation stance. Remind them of the "out."*

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*"We are taught to bow to our instructors and our opponents out of respect. But we rarely extend that respect to ourselves. We beat ourselves up when we make a mistake. We say things to ourselves we would never say to a teammate.*

*Settle in. Bring to mind a mistake you made recently, or a weakness you are frustrated with. Notice the judgment that comes up. 'I should be better.' 'I am slow.' Now, I want you to imagine bowing to that part of yourself.*

*Treat that struggling part of you like a white belt who is trying their best. You wouldn't yell at them; you would guide them.*

*Say to yourself silently: 'I am training. I am learning. It is okay.'*

*Give yourself the same respect you give the dojo. Breathe in acceptance. Breathe out judgment."*

MINDFULNESS ON THE MATS

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